SEO and GEO/AEO Audit: alys-thorne-site.vercel.app

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Scope and limits

I read the homepage, About, Books and Blood Awakens pages. I could not open `robots.txt`, `sitemap.xml` or `llms.txt`, because the fetch tool blocked them. The tool also shows only some head tags and no JSON-LD, so anything marked "unverified" needs a quick check on your side.

Fix first

1. **The Books page canonical points to another domain.** It sets `canonical`, `og:url` and `og:image` to `marieibay.github.io/alys-thorne-site/books.html`. That tells Google your GitHub Pages copy is the real page, so your Vercel page may never rank. Point them at `https://alys-thorne-site.vercel.app/books`. If the GitHub Pages copy is still live, redirect or take it down.
2. **Most pages have no canonical, `og:image`, `og:url` or Twitter card tags.** The homepage, About and Blood Awakens only have title, description, `og:title`, `og:description` and `og:type`. Shares will show no preview image, and canonicals are missing. Use the Books page's tag set as the template, with the correct domain.
3. **A developer note is visible on the live homepage.** "Demo mode — set `newsletterAction` in assets/site.js…" appears under the signup form, and the form does not actually collect emails yet. Connect it or hide the note.
4. **Internal links use `.html` but the site serves clean URLs.** Links point to `/books.html`, and the site redirects to `/books`. Link directly to the clean URLs, and make sure the canonicals and sitemap use them too.

SEO

The on-page basics are solid; the weak spots are thin content and entity signals.

Good

- Titles and meta descriptions are unique on every page I checked.

- There is one clear H1 per page and a logical H2/H3 structure.
- Cover images have descriptive alt text.
- Breadcrumbs and a consistent footer link structure.
- Each book, character and lore topic has its own page.

Needs work

- **Book pages are thin.** Blood Awakens is about 100 words, just the blurb. Add publication date, page count, ISBN, content notes, tropes, an excerpt and reader reviews, and link each book to its characters.
- **The About page is very thin.** It is about 60 words, with an image alt of just "Alys Thorne". Add a real bio, how you got into writing, and your influences, since this page carries your author identity.
- **The homepage description is brand-led and repeated.** Your tagline is reused as the description on the homepage and About. Mention the sapphic vampire romance and the trilogy being complete, because that is what readers search for.
- **Social profile links go to search pages, not your profiles.** The homepage links to Amazon and Goodreads searches. Your Books page already has your actual Goodreads author URL, so use it everywhere.
- **Remove the tracking parameters** (`qid`, `sr`) from the Amazon link on the Books page.
- **The game lives on a separate domain** (`veins-android.vercel.app`). Link to it and consider adding a note on it.

GEO / AEO (AI and answer engines)

The Books page FAQ is the one strong asset; almost everything else here is unverified or missing.

Strong: the Books page has a real Reader FAQ with question-style headings and direct answers. It covers reading order, whether the series is complete, Kindle Unlimited, pairings and tropes, and darkness level. That is the format answer engines like to quote.

Gaps

- **FAQ schema is unverified.** I could not see whether the FAQ is marked up as `FAQPage`. Without it, extraction is less reliable.
- **No other page has Q&A content.** Add short FAQs to each book page ("Do I need to read Book 1 first?", "Is there a cliffhanger?") and to the About page.

- **Structured data is unverified.** Ideally you would have `Person` or `Author` on About with `sameAs` links, `Book` plus `BookSeries` on the series and book pages, and `WebSite` and `BreadcrumbList` sitewide.
- **State key facts in plain sentences** near the top of the page, for example "Veins of Silver is a completed sapphic dark romantic fantasy trilogy." Some of your best facts are only in the FAQ.
- **`llms.txt`, `robots.txt` and AI-crawler rules are unchecked.** Make sure `robots.txt` does not block GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot or Google-Extended unless you want that. An `llms.txt` is optional and low-impact.
- **Entity consistency.** Use the same author name, series name and book titles everywhere, and link to the same Goodreads author page. That helps AI systems tie you to the books.

Check yourself

Four quick checks will close the gaps I could not verify.

- [ ] View source on each page and look for `<link rel="canonical">` and `<script type="application/ld+json">`.
- [ ] Run the homepage, Books page and a book page through Google's Rich Results Test.
- [ ] Open `/robots.txt` and `/sitemap.xml` and confirm the sitemap uses clean Vercel URLs and is listed in robots.txt.
- [ ] Submit the sitemap in Google Search Console.